



◀ INTERNAL HDDs:
**WESTERN DIGITAL
VELOCIRAPTOR 1TB**
Price: ₹14,800

Internal HDDs

Another year went by and though there hasn't been any major change in the storage sector, we've still seen many new product launches but mostly in the solid state storage department. Internal mechanical HDDs still rule the market when you take into account the cost-per-GB or value for money that you get with them. We've seen the prices of most PC components rise due to the dip in the exchange rates and HDD prices did take a hit in Q3 2013. But now, the prices seem to have fallen quite a bit and it's a good time to go for a HDD.

Zero1 Winner

Western Digital Velociraptor 1TB

This came as no surprise. In fact, this has been the trend with internal HDDs since the past couple of years as Western Digital's Velociraptor once again bagged the Zero1 award for being the best performing desktop HDD we've tested. With a capacity of 1TB that runs at 10,000 RPM, a 64MB cache size and SATA 6.0Gb/s, the Velociraptor is one blazing fast drive that left other competitors in the dust.

Notable Mentions

Seagate Desktop SSHD 2TB

This is a hybrid drive from Seagate that's an amalgamation of SSD and HDD technology in the same drive. Instead of being completely mechanical, the Seagate Desktop SSHD uses an 8GB MLC NAND flash chip and the outcome is much more performance. This drive was the best after the Velociraptor, purely in terms of performance.



**Seagate
Desktop SSHD
2TB**
Price: ₹9,600



**WD My Passport
Ultra**
Price: ₹5,999

Portable HDD's

Hard drives have become a necessity for most people these days and portable hard drives are something that make carrying data easier. This year we saw a rise in the number of USB 3.0 portable hard drives and also a few with Thunderbolt. We saw many brands going for the rugged drive design approach with many of their models. A few of these rugged drives that we tested were built very well while some had a flimsy rubber jacket in the name of calling it a rugged drive. A few manufacturers have also come up with portable Solid State Drives but they're pricey.

Zero1 Winner

Silicon Power Armor A15

This was one of the most rugged hard drives we've tested this year. With a great build quality, the Armor A15 has a U.S. military standard rating "US MIL-STD-810F". We actually tested their claim by drop testing this drive from a height and the A15 was unscathed.

Notable Mention

WD My Passport Ultra

The drive was a worthy contender for the best performer's pole position. Though it isn't spectacular in any way in terms of its build quality, it performs very well. The drive also comes with a handy pouch to help owners carry it around with them safely. A good drive to go for.



▲ PORTABLE HDD's:
SILICON POWER ARMOR A15
Price: ₹5,450